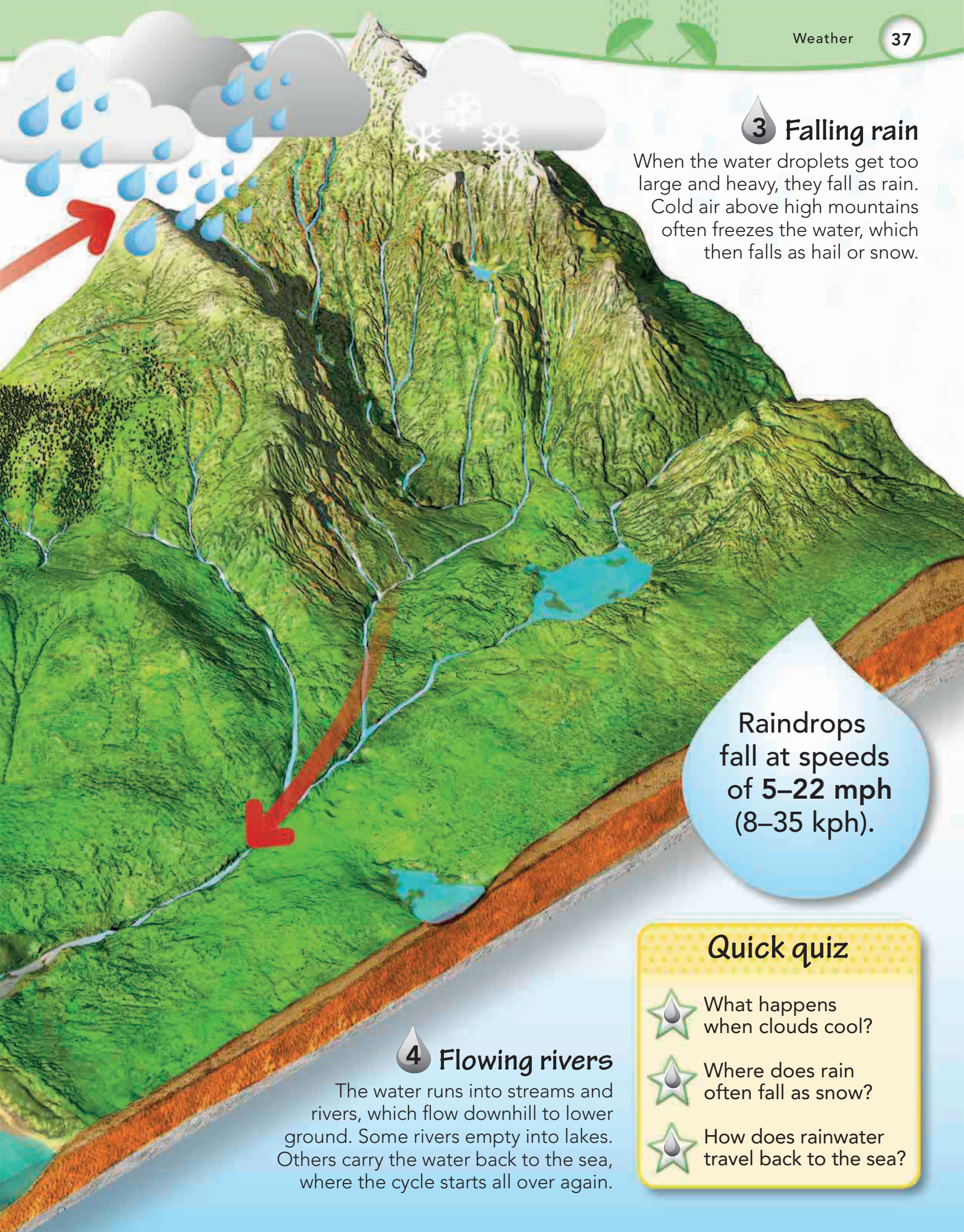




3 Falling rain

When the water droplets get too large and heavy, they fall as rain. Cold air above high mountains often freezes the water, which then falls as hail or snow.

Raindrops fall at speeds of **5–22 mph** (8–35 kph).

4 Flowing rivers

The water runs into streams and rivers, which flow downhill to lower ground. Some rivers empty into lakes. Others carry the water back to the sea, where the cycle starts all over again.

Quick quiz

-  What happens when clouds cool?
-  Where does rain often fall as snow?
-  How does rainwater travel back to the sea?